MAJOR ARMS CONTROL AGREEMENT SINCE 1960

1. *Partial Test Ban Treaty (PTBT):* The PTBT was signed on 8 August 1963 in Moscow and it came into force on 10 October 1963. The basic features of the treaty are:

(a) Under Article I, each of the Parties to the Treaty undertook the responsibility to prohibit, to prevent, and not to carry out any nuclear weapon test explosion, or any other nuclear explosion, at any place under its jurisdiction or control: (i) in the atmosphere; beyond its limits, including outer space; or under water, including territorial waters or high seas; or (ii) in any other environment if such explosion causes radioactive debris to be present outside the territorial limits of the state under whose jurisdiction or control such explosion is conducted.

(b) Each of the Parties to the Treaty undertook further responsibility to refrain from causing, encouraging, or in any way participating in, the carrying out of any nuclear weapon test explosion, or any other nuclear explosion, anywhere which would take place in any of the environments described, or have the effect referred to, in paragraph 1 of this Article.

The Treaty though was a significant step towards disarmament as it aimed to reduce the dangers of radioactive fallout from the nuclear tests in the atmosphere; it was partial because it did not prohibit the nuclear test underground. Both the Soviet Union and the United States conducted a large number of tests underground. France and China declined to sign the Treaty and continued with their nuclear tests in the atmosphere.

2. *Outer Space Treaty, 1967:* The Outer Space Treaty opened for signature on 27 January 1967 and came into force from 10 October 1967.

Article IV of the Treaty stipulates that Parties (states) to the Treaty should undertake not to place in orbit around the Earth any objects carrying nuclear weapons or any other kinds of weapons of mass destruction, install such weapons on celestial bodies, or station such weapons in outer space in any other manner. The Moon and other celestial bodies shall be used by all Parties to the Treaty exclusively